

JETRO Business Brief 2026/09/17

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【ASIA-OCEANIA】

Consumer event featuring 82 Japanese stationery brands held in Shanghai (China)

China's annual intellectual property conference held in Beijing; Huawei and others introduce patent-related initiatives (China)

China's August automobile market sees sluggish domestic sales but exports exceed 1 million units for third consecutive month (China)

Shenzhen-Hong Kong-Guangzhou maintains top ranking in WIPO's Innovation Cluster Index (Hong Kong, China)

Singapore Economic Development Board opens office in Boston, USA (Singapore, USA)

Singapore robot developer QuickBot partners with Mitsubishi Electric and Hitachi High-Tech subsidiaries (Singapore)

Thai House of Representatives approves emergency borrowing decree for energy structure reform (Thailand)

Myanmar President makes state visit to Cambodia; signs four documents on taxation and investment (Myanmar, Cambodia)

【NORTH AMERICA AND LATIN AMERICA】

Automotive parts major Toyotsu invests \$41 million to expand factory in Kentucky, USA (USA, Japan)

US Federal Reserve unanimously raises policy interest rate by 0.25 percentage point; emphasizes commitment to price targets (USA)

US Customs begins accepting applications for IEEPA tariff refunds "Phase 3" from October 6 (USA)

US Commerce Department provides up to \$1 billion support to IBM subsidiary under CHIPS Plus Act for quantum wafer research and development (USA)

First half inbound direct investment increases 31.1% year-on-year (Colombia)

Fujimori administration announces education improvement policy including new school construction (Peru)

Bolivia to completely eliminate fuel subsidies from 2027; begins full-scale fiscal reconstruction (Bolivia)

Brazil enacts preferential tax system for data centers (Brazil)

【EUROPE, RUSSIA, CENTRAL ASIA, AND CAUCASUS】

Q2 GDP growth rate accelerates: EU 0.7% quarter-on-quarter, eurozone 0.6% (EU, Eurozone)

Q2 GDP growth rate 0.0% quarter-on-quarter; growth slows again (Belgium)

Sweden releases provisional election results; opposition alliance leads by narrow margin (Sweden)

Czech Ministry of Industry and Trade announces investment and financing guarantee program for Ukraine reconstruction (Czech Republic, Ukraine)

Nippon Paper halts business operations at Hungary production facility (Hungary, Japan)

【MIDDLE EAST AND AFRICA】

UAE Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi meets Iranian President at BRICS summit (UAE, Iran, India)

August oil market sees supply-demand contraction and inventory decline; diesel fuel shortage deepens (Middle East, World)

Nigeria's Dangote refinery, world's largest crude processing capacity, conducts IPO (Nigeria)

Pan-African payment system transaction volume surges significantly; African Export-Import Bank reports (Africa)